

SOF IEO — Topic Deep-Dive: Adjectives & Degrees of Comparison

For Ambar, Class III CBSE

1. What is an adjective?

An **adjective** is a describing word. It tells us more about a noun — what kind, what colour, what size, how many.

Example: “The **little** bird sang sweetly.” — *little* describes the bird.

Watch out: *sweetly* describes HOW it sang (that is an adverb, not an adjective). If the word ends in *-ly* and answers “how?”, it is usually NOT the adjective. This is the most common trap in “pick the adjective” questions.

Spotting the adjective

Ask: **which word tells me more about a person, animal, place or thing?** - The **brave** soldier stood at the border. → brave - Amma made **hot** parathas. → hot - The **old** man carried a **heavy** sack. → two adjectives!

2. The three degrees of comparison

Degree	Used for	Example
Positive	just describing (no comparing)	Raju is strong .
Comparative (-er / more)	comparing TWO things, with “than”	Raju is stronger than Mohan.
Superlative (-est / most)	comparing THREE or more, with “the”	Raju is the strongest boy in the village.

Clue words: “than” → comparative. “the ... in/of all” → superlative.

3. How to form the degrees

Type of word	Rule	Example
Short words	add -er / -est	tall, taller, tallest
Ending in -e	add -r / -st	wide, wider, widest
Ending in -y	y becomes i	happy, happier, happiest; heavy, heavier, heaviest
Short vowel + consonant	double the last letter	big, bigger, biggest; hot, hotter, hottest
Long words	more / most	beautiful, more beautiful, most beautiful; difficult, more difficult, most difficult

The irregular family (must memorise)

Positive	Comparative	Superlative
good	better	best
bad	worse	worst
many/much	more	most
little	less	least
far	farther	farthest

4. Common traps

Trap	Wrong	Right
Double comparison	more bigger, most tastiest	bigger, tastiest
Made-up forms	gooder, goodest, badder, farer	better, best, worse, farther
-er with three or more	Riya is taller in the class.	Riya is the tallest in the class.
-est with "than"	Riya is tallest than Sonu.	Riya is taller than Sonu.
"more" with short words	more tall, more sweet	taller, sweeter
Adverb instead of adjective	She is a sweetly girl.	She is a sweet girl.
Missing "the" before superlative	He is best player.	He is the best player.

Golden rule: never use "more/most" together with "-er/-est" in the same phrase.

5. High-frequency IEO question types

1. **Pick the adjective** from a sentence (distractors: verb, adverb, noun).
2. **Fill the blank with correct degree** — "An elephant is ___ than a horse." (bigger)
3. **Superlative with a group** — "Of the three sisters, Riya is the ___." (tallest)
4. **Error spotting** — find "more bigger" / "most tastiest".
5. **Correct-pair question** — "good - better - best" vs wrong chains.
6. **Double blank (Achiever's)** — "Ravi is ___ than Sohan, but Mohan is the ___ of the three." (taller, tallest)

6. Key facts checklist

- Adjective = describing word for a noun.
- Two things + "than" → -er / more.
- Three or more + "the" → -est / most.
- good-better-best, bad-worse-worst, far-farther-farthest, little-less-least.
- y → i: happy-happier; double letters: big-bigger, hot-hotter.
- Long words take more/most, never -er/-est (no "difficulter").
- Never double up: "more taller" is always wrong.

7. Quick drill (10 questions)

1. Pick the adjective: "The naughty puppy chewed the shoe." (puppy / naughty / chewed / shoe)
2. A feather is ___ than a coin. (light / lighter / lightest / most light)
3. Mount Everest is the ___ peak in the world. (high / higher / highest / more high)
4. My kheer is good, but Dadi's kheer is ___. (better / best / gooder / more good)
5. This is the ___ story in the whole book. (interesting / more interesting / most interesting / interestinger)
6. Find the error: "Chennai is more hotter than Shimla." (Chennai / is / more hotter / than)
7. Of the two bags, this one is ___. (heaviest / heavier / most heavy / more heaviest)
8. The ___ I ran, the more tired I felt. (fast / faster / fastest / most fast)
9. Which pair is wrong? (big-bigger-biggest / bad-worse-worst / good-better-best / far-farer-farest)
10. Winter is the ___ season of the year. (cold / colder / coldest / more cold)

Answers: 1. naughty 2. lighter 3. highest 4. better 5. most interesting 6. more hotter (should be *hotter*) 7. heavier 8. faster 9. far-farer-farest (should be *far-farther-farthest*) 10. coldest